

Is DevRel a Role For You?

Are you a developer who loves to build relationships with developer communities? Are you looking for a transition from a coding role to one that involves developer relations? In a conversation with *Rahul Chopra*, *Niraj Sahay* and *Abbinaya Kuzhanthaivel* of *OSFY*, *Prashanth Subrahmanyam*, **developer advocate at Google**, sheds light on this hot role with some practical advice to help you kick-start your journey.



Prashanth Subrahmanyam,
developer advocate at Google



Q. What does the term ‘developer relations’ mean?

A. Developer relations is a term that is probably overused or has different interpretations. There are cases where it's aligned to the sales or marketing department in different companies. Some of them even term it as developer evangelism.

At Google, ‘developer relations’ is a part of a larger core engineering team. We work closely with engineering teams and with product management teams. We are expected to be technical experts in specialised topics and products, and are uniquely positioned to work closely with the developer community.

We talk to developers and try to get their feedback. I am a developer advocate for Google Cloud and we try to understand how developers view Google Cloud products and how they use them. What is it that they are looking for? What is their feedback about the Google products they are using? What are some use cases they work on, and how difficult or easy is it for them to use these products? What are the likes and dislikes? And so on...

We work both ways. We also give feedback to the developers based on their inputs. What are they finding issues with? What do they want to know more about? What will help

them in their usage of Google tools and Google products? This is the kind of information we give back. It could be in the form of articles, blogs, videos, code snippets, and architecture documents, or maybe connecting with other people who have been in this space and are ready to share their experiences to benefit the larger community.

This two-way scenario becomes important because we are the zeroth customer for engineering teams. And as the product is being built, we act as advocates on behalf of developers for the product team work. We try to use the new features that have been released and channel the feedback to product management and engineering.